

Overview

項目	托福新制	
測驗設計	閱讀/聽力採多階段適性測驗	
考題內容	真實學術情境, 跨文化設計	
分數呈現	同現 0–120 分制; 1–6 級分; CEFR 等級	
出分速度	最快 72 小時內	
在家測驗監考	ETS 官方訓練專員 + AI 驗證	
聽力 ~47 題 ~29 分鐘	Single Question Multiple Questions (2~4)	聆聽句子 Best Response 對話（生活情境）Conversation 公告 Announcement 學術講座 Lecture
口說 11 題 8 分鐘	P1. Listen and Repeat P2. Take an Interview	跟讀句子 7 句 面試式問答 4 題

Google Drive



Announcement 1

1 What is the main topic of the announcement?

- (A) A schedule for chemistry exams
- (B) A change in laboratory location
- (C) A decrease in course enrollment
- (D) A new safety training program

2 Why does the speaker mention the cafeteria?

- (A) To suggest a meeting point for students
- (B) To announce a change in lunch schedules
- (C) To provide a reference for walking distance
- (D) To clarify where to find laboratory maps

3 What does the speaker urge students to do today?

- (A) Sign up for individual workstations
- (B) Consult a map of the campus
- (C) Purchase new safety equipment
- (D) Register for a different chemistry section

Script:

W: Due to a sudden increase in enrollment for this chemistry course, our current laboratory space has become quite insufficient. So, **starting next Tuesday, we will be conducting our weekly experiments in the Advanced Science Center instead of the basement lab.** Please take note that the new facility is significantly more spacious and contains updated safety equipment. **Since the center is on the far north side of campus, it might take a few extra minutes to walk there from the cafeteria.** However, the larger workstations will permit everyone to work individually. **Please ensure you check the campus map today to find the exact entrance.**

Announcement 2

1 What is the main purpose of the announcement?

- (A) To recruit staff for weekend shifts
- (B) To explain new student safety regulations
- (C) To describe a research schedule update
- (D) To announce a change in library hours

2 What is the reason for the modified schedule?

- (A) The installation of new study furniture
- (B) An expansion of the research department
- (C) A holiday celebration for the faculty
- (D) Required electrical work in the building

3 What does the speaker advise the listeners to do?

- (A) Submit their research papers early
- (B) Report any technical issues to staff
- (C) Visit a different library on campus
- (D) Adjust their study plans for the weekend

Script:

W: Attention students and faculty. **Due to essential electrical maintenance in the building, the university library will modify its operating hours this weekend.** Instead of the usual midnight closure, the building will shut down at six o'clock on Saturday evening. We expect the technical repairs to conclude by Sunday morning. So, the facility will reopen for normal study sessions starting at noon the following day. We understand this adjustment might disrupt your research schedules, but ensuring safety within our facilities remains our primary concern. **Please plan your study sessions accordingly.** We appreciate your cooperation and patience during these necessary improvements.

Conversation 1

1 What is the woman's primary concern?

- (A) Finding a location for a workshop
- (B) Interviewing a new IT consultant
- (C) Meeting with the board of directors
- (D) Repairing some office computers

2 What does the man offer to do if the IT consultant is unavailable on Wednesday?

- (A) Assist in finding a space outside the office
- (B) Conduct the training session himself
- (C) Contact the board members to request a room
- (D) Postpone the training until the next month

3 What will the woman do next?

- (A) Contact a guest speaker
- (B) Talk to the board members
- (C) Visit a nearby venue
- (D) Reserve an off-site room

Script:

W: **I'm having trouble finding a room for the software training workshop next Tuesday.** Every conference room is already booked.

M: That's because the board members are in town for their annual review. They've reserved all the large spaces for the entire week.

W: I see. In that case, should we push the session back to following Monday? I need to make sure everyone has a desk and a working computer.

M: Actually, Monday is a holiday, so the office will be closed. Why don't you try the following Wednesday instead?

W: That sounds great, but I'll need to check if the IT consultant is available then. He's the one leading the session.

M: Good point. If he's busy, let me know right away. **I can help you look for an off-site venue nearby as a backup plan.**

W: Thanks! **I'll send him an email now and let you know what he says.**

Conversation 2

1 What problem are the speakers trying to solve?

- (A) A technical error is affecting a digital presentation
- (B) A software update has deleted important video files
- (C) A staff member is late to a training session
- (D) A client has canceled a scheduled meeting

2 According to the woman, what happens when she uses the software?

- (A) The audio fails to play
- (B) The application closes unexpectedly
- (C) The computer screen freezes
- (D) The video quality becomes poor

3 What is the woman's concern about the man's initial suggestion?

- (A) She does not know how to convert video formats
- (B) She does not have enough time before the deadline
- (C) She thinks the file quality will be too low
- (D) She believes the converter is also broken

Script:

W: Do you have a minute? **I'm having trouble with the new presentation software for this afternoon's client meeting.**

M: Sure, what's going on? I heard it had some bugs after the last update.

W: Exactly. **Every time I try to embed the video samples, the program shuts down.** I've tried restarting twice, but no luck.

M: That sounds frustrating. Maybe we should try converting the video files to a different format first?

W: That's a good idea, though **I'm worried it might take too long. The meeting starts in an hour.**

M: Don't worry. Why don't you send the files to me? I can run them through the converter while you finalize the slides.

W: That would be great! I'll email them to you right away. Thanks for the help.

M: No problem! Let's get this wrapped up so you're ready to go.

Academic Vocabulary

Word	Example Sentence
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Lecture 1

1 What is the main topic of the talk?

- (A) The impact of pollution on deep-sea habitats
- (B) The history of deep-sea exploration
- (C) The evolution of light-sensing organs in fish
- (D) The process and functions of bioluminescence

2 What can be inferred about the enzyme luciferase?

- (A) An organism needs a constant new supply because it is used up quickly.
- (B) It is the main source of food for many deep-sea creatures.
- (C) It would be less effective if the temperature of the water increased.
- (D) It remains present in the body even after the light is produced.

3 According to the lecture, what defines the light produced by these organisms as "cold light"?

- (A) The light is produced by organisms living in freezing water.
- (B) The light requires freezing oxygen to start the chemical reaction.
- (C) The light production involves very little thermal energy loss.
- (D) The light is only visible in extremely low temperatures.

4 What will the speaker most likely discuss next?

- (A) The diet of shallow-water predatory fish
- (B) The specific way diseases are tracked using light proteins
- (C) Methods for reducing carbon dioxide in the atmosphere
- (D) The history of deep-sea diving equipment

Script:

Today's topic is the incredible ability of certain deep-sea creatures to create their own light, a phenomenon scientists call bioluminescence. In the pitch-black environment of the midnight zone, being able to glow is a major survival advantage. The mechanism works as follows. It involves a chemical reaction inside the organism's body. This process begins when a molecule called luciferin reacts with oxygen. **What enables this is a specific enzyme known as luciferase, which acts as a catalyst to speed up the reaction without getting used up itself. The sequence involves the release of energy in the form of cold light, meaning almost no heat is produced during the glow.** This is crucial because it prevents the animal from wasting energy or damaging its own tissues in the high-pressure depths of the ocean. Many fish use this light for communication, to attract a mate, or to lure unsuspecting prey into their mouths. Some even use it as a form of camouflage to hide their shadows from predators swimming below them. However, ocean acidification is a growing threat because it can change the chemical balance of seawater. This might interfere with the pH levels needed for these delicate enzymes to work properly. **The significance of understanding bioluminescence goes beyond biology, as researchers are now using these same light-producing proteins in medical imaging to track how diseases spread through human cells.**

Lecture 2

1 What is the lecture mainly about?

- (A) The common predators of wood frogs in northern climates
- (B) The migration patterns of North American amphibians
- (C) The impact of rising temperatures on frog breeding habits
- (D) The physiological ability of wood frogs to survive freezing

2 According to the speaker, what happens to the wood frog's heart when it freezes?

- (A) It stops beating completely until the spring.
- (B) It maintains a high temperature to protect organs.
- (C) It pumps glucose throughout the frozen body.
- (D) It beats at a much slower rate than usual.

3 The speaker mentions the wood frog's northern habitat in order to:

- (A) Contrast the wood frog's range with that of other cold-blooded animals.
- (B) Argue that all vertebrates are moving toward the poles.
- (C) Prove that most amphibians prefer cold climates for breeding.
- (D) Demonstrate the superiority of the frog's internal chemistry over other species.

4 According to the speaker, the wood frog's survival strategy involves all of the following EXCEPT:

- (A) Warming from the inside out when spring arrives
- (B) Maintaining high levels of physical activity in winter
- (C) High concentrations of glucose
- (D) Protective measures against cell dehydration

Script:

The wood frog is a small North American amphibian with a truly incredible ability to survive in freezing northern climates. What makes the wood frog distinctive is its capacity to literally freeze solid during the winter months. When the temperature drops below freezing, the frog's heart stops beating and its breathing ceases entirely. Roughly two-thirds of its body water turns into ice, yet it remains alive. Equally remarkable is the frog's internal chemistry. To prevent its cells from being crushed by ice crystals, *the frog floods its bloodstream with high concentrations of glucose*, which acts as a natural antifreeze. *This sugar prevents the cells from dehydrating* and keeps the vital organs intact even as the spaces between them fill with ice. Another significant aspect is the frog's speed of recovery. When spring arrives and the ice thaws, the frog doesn't need weeks to heal. *It begins to warm from the inside out*, and within a few hours, its heart restarts and it hops away to find a breeding pond. **These elements converge in a specialized survival strategy that allows the wood frog to inhabit regions much further north than any other cold-blooded vertebrate.** This combination of factors highlights how extreme environmental pressures can drive the evolution of unique biological solutions. It reminds us that life often finds ways to persist in conditions that seem completely inhospitable to survival.

Lecture 3

1 What is the lecture mainly about?

- (A) The process and function of RNA interference
- (B) The history of molecular biology discoveries
- (C) The evolution of viral replication methods
- (D) The structure of different eukaryotic enzymes

2 According to the speaker, what is a primary threat that triggers the cell's RNAi response?

- (A) Instability within the cell's own genome
- (B) The overproduction of Dicer enzymes
- (C) A lack of available messenger RNA in the cell
- (D) The successful translation of suppressor proteins

3 What can be inferred about the process of protein synthesis when the RISC complex is active?

- (A) Proteins will be synthesized in the nucleus instead of the cytoplasm.
- (B) Protein production from specific target genes will be blocked.
- (C) The cell will stop producing all types of proteins.
- (D) Protein synthesis is likely to increase rapidly.

4 Regarding the application of RNAi, what does the speaker say about its use in biotechnology?

- (A) It is used to create more resilient viral strains.
- (B) It is used to synthesize new types of proteins.
- (C) It helps researchers map the entire human genome.
- (D) It allows scientists to turn off specific harmful genes.

Script:

Molecular biology has recently uncovered a sophisticated internal defense system within eukaryotic cells known as RNA interference, or RNAi. The mechanism works as follows to regulate gene expression and defend against viral threats. This process begins when double-stranded RNA molecules enter the cell, which the cell perceives as a sign of viral infection or genomic instability. What enables this is a specialized enzyme called Dicer, which cleaves these long strands into much smaller fragments known as short interfering RNAs. The sequence involves these small fragments being loaded into a protein complex called RISC, the RNA-induced silencing complex. This complex then scans the cell for messenger RNA strands that match the sequence of the fragments. Once a match is found, **the RISC complex binds to the target mRNA and degrades it, effectively preventing the gene from being translated into a protein.** This is crucial because it allows the cell to pinpoint and silence specific genes with surgical precision, maintaining cellular health and stability. However, the system is not infallible, as some advanced viruses have evolved 'suppressor proteins' that can inhibit the RNAi machinery, allowing the virus to replicate unnoticed. Despite these viral countermeasures, **the discovery of RNAi has revolutionized biotechnology, providing researchers with a potent tool to suppress disease-causing genes in the laboratory.** This discovery reshaped our understanding of the hidden regulatory layers that govern the very blueprint of life within our cells.

Lecture 4

1 What is the main topic of the talk?

- (A) The historical reliance of gymnosperms on wind
- (B) The role of Charles Darwin in modern botany
- (C) The chemical composition of modern scents
- (D) The evolutionary rise and success of flowering plants

2 What challenge did plants face BEFORE the emergence of angiospermic flowers?

- (A) An inability to survive without large amounts of caloric input
- (B) Inefficient dispersal due to reliance on inanimate forces like wind
- (C) A lack of terrestrial landscapes available for colonization
- (D) Competition from animals that ate their unprotected seeds

3 What can be inferred about gymnosperms like conifers compared to angiosperms?

- (A) They appeared much later in history than flowers
- (B) They comprise the majority of modern terrestrial species
- (C) They were more efficient at spreading seeds via fruit
- (D) They did not evolve specialized flowers to attract animals

4 The speaker states that angiosperms are currently significant to humanity because:

- (A) They are the only group that survives in all climates
- (B) They serve as the main source of modern antibiotics
- (C) They provide the majority of human food energy
- (D) They stabilize the global climate through scent

Script:

You're probably familiar with the vibrant colors and scents of modern flowers, but the world was not always so aesthetically diverse. Its origins trace back to the early Cretaceous period, approximately one hundred and forty million years ago. **Before this era, the terrestrial landscape was dominated by gymnosperms, such as conifers and cycads, which relied primarily on the wind for reproduction. A defining characteristic of the emerging angiosperms was the development of the flower itself, a specialized reproductive structure designed to attract animal pollinators.** The turning point came when these plants began to co-evolve with insects, creating a symbiotic relationship that accelerated the diversification of both groups. By the mid-Cretaceous, it had become clear that flowering plants possessed a distinct competitive advantage, as their protected seeds within fruits allowed for superior dispersal by animals. This evolutionary leap triggered what Charles Darwin famously described as an 'abominable mystery' due to the startlingly rapid appearance of diverse species in the fossil record. **Today, it continues to be the dominant plant group on Earth, comprising over ninety percent of all terrestrial plant species and providing the primary caloric basis for human civilization.** This vast biological success illustrates how a single structural innovation can transform the entire ecological architecture of the planet. What began as a local botanical shift has now become the fundamental backbone of nearly every terrestrial ecosystem on the globe.

Lecture 5

1 What is the lecture mainly about?

- (A) Changes in animal size due to island isolation
- (B) The discovery of prehistoric reptiles in Indonesia
- (C) The extinction of flightless birds in New Zealand
- (D) The migration patterns of mainland elephants

2 According to the speaker, what difficulty arises for island species in terms of territory?

- (A) Island species cannot revert to their original sizes.
- (B) Predators from the mainland frequently invade islands.
- (C) Islands have a limited supply of natural resources.
- (D) Evolutionary changes take millions of years to occur.

3 The speaker brings up isolated ecosystems at the end of the lecture in order to:

- (A) Highlight the scientific value of these geographic areas
- (B) Argue for the protection of New Zealand's environment
- (C) Summarize the specific survival rates of reptile species
- (D) Suggest that evolution only happens in small spaces

4 All of the following are discussed as locations for these evolutionary changes EXCEPT:

- (A) Galápagos Islands
- (B) Indonesia
- (C) Australia
- (D) New Zealand

Script:

In the study of island biogeography, we see a fascinating pattern where species change size when they are isolated from the mainland. *In the Galápagos Islands, we find the iconic giant tortoises.* Without any large predators to hunt them and with limited competition for food, these reptiles evolved to be much larger than their ancestors on South America. *Meanwhile, in Indonesia, on the island of Flores, we see the opposite effect with the Komodo dragon.* While it is the largest lizard today, it actually represents a form of gigantism compared to its prehistoric relatives. A striking contrast emerges in the fossil record of the Mediterranean islands, specifically with extinct pygmy elephants. Here, huge mainland elephants became tiny, some only the size of a large dog, because small islands could not provide enough food to support a massive body. In contrast, *New Zealand provides a famous example of bird gigantism* with the Moa, a flightless bird that grew up to twelve feet tall because there were no mammals to compete with. Despite these differences, a common thread is that island environments remove the usual rules of the mainland. Across all these traditions of evolution, **the lack of predators and the limit of resources force animals to adapt their body size to survive.** This phenomenon shows how geography can completely rewrite the physical traits of a species in a relatively short amount of time. **Together, these factors illustrate why isolated ecosystems serve as such vital natural laboratories for modern evolutionary science.**

Lecture 6

1 What is the lecture mainly about?

- (A) The history of gray wolves in Yellowstone
- (B) The role of keystone species in ecosystems
- (C) The classification of different forest types
- (D) The biological structure of cell membranes

2 What is the purpose of discussing the reintroduction of gray wolves in Yellowstone?

- (A) To show how one species can influence an entire ecological structure
- (B) To contrast terrestrial ecosystems with marine environments
- (C) To prove that carnivores are more important than herbivores
- (D) To argue that elk populations should be strictly controlled by humans

3 The speaker implies that the term 'celebrity species' is used to describe:

- (A) Scientists who popularize the study of kelp forests
- (B) Organisms that are widely known and receive most conservation funding
- (C) Small organisms like those involved in soil aeration
- (D) Species that have recently become extinct in the Pacific

4 Which of the following functions of small organisms is NOT explicitly mentioned?

- (A) Nutrient recycling
- (B) Pollination
- (C) Soil aeration
- (D) Maintaining stability

Script:

In cellular biology, the term 'selectivity' refers to the ability of a membrane to allow only certain substances through while blocking others. Think of it this way: a cell membrane acts like a high-security gatekeeper that maintains the internal environment of the cell regardless of the chaos outside. The parallel here is the concept of a 'keystone species' in conservation ecology. **Just as a gatekeeper controls the flow of a building, a keystone species regulates the entire structure of an ecosystem.** Take the classic example of gray wolves in Yellowstone National Park. **When they were reintroduced, they didn't just hunt elk; they changed the behavior of the entire ecosystem, leading to the regrowth of trees and the return of various bird species.** Now, think about the sea otter in the kelp forests of the Pacific. By eating sea urchins, otters prevent the urchins from destroying the kelp, which provides a habitat for hundreds of other organisms. Without the otter, the entire system collapses into an 'urchin barren.' These examples show that the health of an environment often depends on just one or two critical players. However, a potential downside of focusing exclusively on keystone species is that we might neglect the broader biodiversity of an area. Modern conservationists worry that by pouring all resources into one 'celebrity' species, we might ignore smaller, less visible organisms that perform vital functions like soil aeration or *pollination*. *This reminds us that even small changes can have profound effects on the stability of our natural world.*

Lecture 7

1 What is the main topic of the talk?

- (A) The history of natural cloning technology
- (B) A unique form of asexual reproduction
- (C) The risks of viral infections in zoos
- (D) The mating rituals of Komodo dragons

2 The speaker states that a primary advantage of parthenogenesis for a species is:

- (A) The ability to produce stronger male offspring
- (B) Preservation of energy during the reproductive cycle
- (C) Increased resistance to environmental viruses
- (D) The creation of more diverse offspring

3 What is a possible problem with the genetic makeup of parthenogenic offspring?

- (A) They require more energy to survive than sexual offspring
- (B) They lack the variety needed to resist widespread illness
- (C) They often develop physical deformities quickly
- (D) They are unable to reproduce when they reach adulthood

4 What will the speaker most likely discuss next?

- (A) The chemical composition of dragon scales
- (B) How species might adapt to future genetic risks
- (C) A comparison between reptiles and birds
- (D) The history of zoo management in Europe

Script:

Today, we're going to talk about a unique form of reproduction known as parthenogenesis. Parthenogenesis refers to a process where an embryo develops from an unfertilized egg, meaning offspring are produced without a male genetic contribution. In many ways, it is like a form of natural cloning. This has gained traction because it allows certain species to survive in environments where mates are hard to find. The benefit is clear for isolated populations; for example, a female Komodo dragon in a zoo or on a distant island can still produce young even if no males are around. This ensures that the population doesn't go extinct in the short term. Furthermore, it saves the energy that would usually be spent on finding a partner and performing mating rituals. On the other hand, there are major long-term risks. Because the offspring are genetic copies or very similar to the mother, there is a total lack of genetic diversity. This makes the whole population more vulnerable to diseases or changes in the climate because they all have the same weaknesses. If a virus can kill one individual, it can likely kill them all. This balance between immediate survival and long-term adaptation is a central theme in evolutionary biology. It shows how nature prioritizes the continuation of a species, even if it comes at the cost of future flexibility. The question remains: how will future generations balance these genetic disadvantages if the environment changes suddenly?

Lecture 8

1 What is the main topic of the talk?

- (A) The history of marine life in the ocean
- (B) The process of manufacturing bicarbonate
- (C) How chemical buffer systems maintain stability
- (D) The creation of mechanical shock absorbers

2 What can be inferred about a person whose bicarbonate buffer system is not working?

- (A) They would have very low levels of lactic acid.
- (B) They would be able to run much faster than usual.
- (C) They would grow coral reefs more efficiently.
- (D) Their blood pH would fluctuate dangerously.

3 According to the speaker, what happens to the bicarbonate buffer system during intense exercise?

- (A) It signals the carpal muscles to stop working immediately.
- (B) It prevents the blood from becoming excessively acidic.
- (C) It converts blood into a thick physical shock absorber.
- (D) It increases the production of lactic acid in the muscles.

4 The speaker mentions all of the following regarding buffer limitations EXCEPT:

- (A) The speed of environmental change
- (B) The magnitude of the chemical impact
- (C) The capacity limit of the system
- (D) The exact age of the buffer system

Script:

In chemistry, a shock absorber refers to a mechanical device that dampens the impact of a physical blow to prevent damage. Think of it this way: just as a car needs springs to handle a bumpy road, our bodies need a chemical version to handle sudden changes. **The parallel here is a biological buffer system, which keeps our internal pH stable even when we eat or drink something acidic.** In the human body, the most important one is the bicarbonate buffer system. Take the example of intense exercise: when your muscles produce lactic acid, it enters the bloodstream. **Instead of your blood becoming too acidic, the buffer system reacts quickly to neutralize it.** Now, think about the ocean's coral reefs as a second example. The seawater acts as a massive buffer that absorbs carbon dioxide from the air. This keeps the ocean's acidity at a level where marine life can still build healthy shells. However, there is a limitation to these systems. Just like a mechanical shock absorber can break if the impact is too strong, biological buffers have a capacity limit. If the environment changes too fast or too much, the buffer can't keep up, which is what we see happening with ocean acidification today. Understanding these limits is key to seeing how sensitive life really is to chemical changes.

Speaking Task 1

Set 1: Art Museum Guide

You are being trained to guide visitors in an art museum. Listen to your trainer and repeat what he says. Repeat only once.

1 Is this your first time at our museum?

2 For modern art, visit the eastern wing.

3 Classical paintings are located on the second floor.

4 The new exhibit of self portraits is very popular.

5 We offer group tours of gallery highlights at no extra charge.

6 Unfortunately, the sculpture hall is currently under renovation.

7 Our gift shop is running a special promotion on a wide selection of books.

Set 2: Museum Tour

You are being trained to help visitors during a museum tour. Listen to your trainer and repeat what she says. Repeat only once.

- 1 The ticket counter is over there.
- 2 We have maps to help you find your way.
- 3 It's a good idea to start at the central gallery.
- 4 Or take a self-guided tour to explore our most famous items.
- 5 Don't forget to budget extra time for our popular gift shop.
- 6 This week is your last chance to see the special exhibit on photography.
- 7 Check out our calendar of upcoming events, many of which are family friendly.

Speaking Task 2

Set 1: Aging and Elderly Care

You have agreed to take part in a research study about aging and elderly care. You will have a short online interview with a researcher. The researcher will ask you some questions.

Q1: Thank you for joining the study. Today, I'd like to ask you some questions about aging and elderly care. First, is it important to you to spend time with elderly family members, such as grandparents? Why or why not?

Q2: I see. In many families, caring for aging relatives involves different approaches. Some families keep elderly members at home, while others seek professional care facilities. What is the typical approach in your family or community, and what do you think influences that choice?

Q3: Interesting. Many countries are experiencing an aging population. What do you think are one or two ways that communities could better support elderly residents?

Q4: Good points. Lastly, looking to the future, do you think society's attitudes toward aging will change? For example, do you think people will continue working well past the traditional retirement age, or will retirement remain a priority? Explain your thoughts.

Set 1: Interview Aids

Q1: Thank you for joining the study. Today, I'd like to ask you some questions about aging and elderly care. First, is it im

Brainstorming Table:

Answer Angle	\$ (Money)	Time	Ppl (Connection)	Extra (Skill/Health)
Important: Cultural Heritage and Wisdom	Learning practical financial management like traditional budgeting or saving strategies; inheritance planning and understanding family assets.	Investing hours in listening to oral histories; preserving genealogical records that would otherwise be lost over decades.	Strengthening the intergenerational bond; bridging the gap between youth and elders to ensure family traditions continue.	Gaining historical perspective on global events; learning traditional skills like gardening, cooking, or craftsmanship from experts.
Important: Emotional Support and Care	Reducing the high cost of professional elder care services; sharing household expenses through multi-generational living arrangements.	Allocating weekend blocks for social visits; balancing work schedules to provide companionship and prevent loneliness.	Reducing social isolation for the elderly; improving the emotional well-being and empathy levels of younger family members.	Monitoring the physical health of grandparents to catch illnesses early; mental stimulation for seniors which can delay cognitive decline.
Low Priority: Career and Modern Productivity	Maximizing earning potential by focusing on high-demand work; avoiding the 'caregiver penalty' that reduces long-term retirement savings.	Prioritizing limited off-hours for professional networking; dedicating time to intensive skill acquisition required in the modern tech economy.	Building a peer-based professional network; focusing on immediate family units like spouses and children who share current life stages.	Focusing on personal mental health and avoiding burnout from caregiving; pursuing fitness and hobbies that require peak physical energy.
Low Priority: Geographical and Lifestyle Independence	Saving on travel costs for long-distance visits; avoiding the costs of maintaining a large family home suitable for seniors.	Saving hours previously spent on commuting to distant hometowns; gaining flexibility for spontaneous travel or relocation.	Developing a 'chosen family' of friends and mentors in a new city; maintaining digital-only connections to save social energy.	Developing total self-reliance and independence; focusing on contemporary health trends and modern medical advice over outdated remedies.

Model Answers:

3.5–4.5 (B2):

Honestly, I feel that spending time with elderly family is essential for emotional support. The biggest thing for me is reducing the social isolation that many seniors feel when they live alone. By visiting my grandfather every weekend, I can monitor his physical health and make sure he is staying active, which helps catch small medical issues before they become serious emergencies. On top of that, these visits are great for my own empathy. Seeing the world through his eyes helps me slow down and appreciate life more, and the mental stimulation of our long conversations actually helps keep his mind sharp and prevents cognitive decline.

4.5–5.0 (C1):

For me, visiting elderly relatives is a lower priority because I need to focus on my career and modern productivity during this stage of my life. My main concern is maximizing my earning potential while I am young, which requires dedicating my limited off-hours to intensive skill acquisition and professional networking. If I spend every weekend traveling to visit distant relatives, I lose the time needed to stay competitive in the fast-paced tech economy. Additionally, there is a real caregiver penalty that can hurt your long-term retirement savings if you prioritize family care over your own work advancement. I prefer to build a peer-based network of people who share my current professional challenges and goals because these connections provide the support I need to

Q2: I see. In many families, caring for aging relatives involves different approaches. Some families keep elderly members at

Brainstorming Table:

Answer Angle	\$ (Money)	Time	Ppl (Connection)	Extra (Skill/Health)
In-home care: Focusing on emotional well-being and family bonds	Eliminates high monthly facility fees; allows for pooling of resources like shared utility bills and grocery costs.	Requires a significant commitment for daily tasks like feeding and bathing; often involves rotating shifts among siblings to manage the workload.	Strengthens intergenerational bonds as grandchildren interact daily with elders; prevents the depression and isolation often found in clinical settings.	Maintains the elder's cognitive health through familiar surroundings; family members develop practical nursing skills and empathy.
In-home care: Focusing on cultural tradition and moral duty	Keeping the family home intact avoids the need to liquidate assets or sell property to pay for institutional care.	Can lead to 'caregiver burnout' as family members sacrifice their leisure time and career advancement to remain at home.	Fulfills the cultural expectation of filial piety; ensures the senior remains a central figure in community religious or social gatherings.	Elders often live longer due to personalized home-cooked meals; caregivers gain a profound sense of purpose and ethical satisfaction.
Professional facilities: Focusing on medical expertise and safety	High upfront costs are offset by the inclusion of 24/7 medical monitoring and emergency response equipment that is too expensive for a private home.	Frees up family members to remain productive in their careers; visits become quality social time rather than stressful task-oriented labor.	Provides a social circle of peers for the elderly; prevents the resentment that can build when a family member is forced into a full-time nursing role.	Ensures immediate access to physical therapy and specialized dementia care; reduces the risk of household accidents like falls or medication errors.
Professional facilities: Focusing on independence and modern lifestyle	Predictable monthly budgeting replaces the fluctuating costs of home modifications like installing ramps or stairlifts.	Eliminates the time-consuming logistics of transporting seniors to various specialist appointments, as many doctors visit the facility.	Allows the elderly to maintain a sense of autonomy away from their children; offers organized group activities like bridge clubs or gardening circles.	Facilities offer structured nutrition plans tailored to specific health conditions; residents benefit from professionally designed exercise programs for mobility.

Model Answers:

3.5–4.5 (B2):

In my culture, keeping aging relatives at home is the standard approach because it is seen as a moral duty. Many people feel a strong sense of filial piety and want to ensure their parents remain part of the local community. By staying at home, the elders can continue attending religious services and social gatherings with their lifelong friends. While it can lead to caregiver burnout because family members sacrifice their own leisure time, it also protects the family wealth. Instead of liquidating property to pay for institutional fees, the family home remains intact and is passed down to the next generation while the senior receives

4.5–5.0 (C1):

Most families I know are moving toward professional care facilities because they prioritize medical expertise and safety. The biggest advantage is the twenty-four-hour monitoring provided by trained nurses. If a senior has a sudden fall or a medication error at home, it can be fatal, but in a facility, they have immediate access to emergency response equipment. Furthermore, this transition changes the dynamic of family relationships. Instead of spending every visit performing stressful physical labor like bathing or feeding, children can actually enjoy quality social time with their parents. This prevents the resentment that often builds up when a family member is forced into a full-time nursing role and allows for

Q3: Interesting. Many countries are experiencing an aging population. What do you think are one or two ways that communities

Brainstorming Table:

Answer Angle	\$ (Money)	Time	Ppl (Connection)	Extra (Skill/Health)
Institutional Support: Developing Specialized Infrastructure	Government funding for retrofitting public transit with ramps and elevators; tax incentives for developers building senior-living complexes; high initial capital expenditure for specialized medical clinics.	Long-term planning required for urban zoning changes; reduced transit time for seniors using dedicated shuttle services; faster emergency response times through localized care centers.	Increased interaction within age-segregated housing communities; professionalization of caregiving roles; reduced burden on family members who act as primary caregivers.	Improved physical mobility through walkable neighborhoods; better management of chronic conditions like arthritis or dementia; enhanced safety via fall-prevention architecture.
Institutional Support: Enhancing Financial and Healthcare Policy	Subsidizing prescription drug costs to prevent bankruptcy; increasing pension payouts to match inflation; lowering property taxes for retirees on fixed incomes.	Streamlining bureaucratic processes for accessing medical benefits; reducing wait times for geriatric specialists; time saved by digitizing health records for coordinated care.	Reduced financial stress allowing seniors to engage in leisure activities; strengthening the economic stability of households with multi-generational dependents.	Lower stress levels improving cardiovascular health; increased access to preventative screenings; higher levels of self-rated well-being and life satisfaction.
Community Integration: Intergenerational Mentorship Programs	Low-cost implementation using existing community centers; potential for seniors to earn small stipends as tutors; reduced youth delinquency costs through adult guidance.	Scheduled weekly sessions for storytelling or skill-sharing; flexible volunteering hours for retirees; time invested in building long-term neighborhood rapport.	Combatting elderly isolation by connecting them with energetic youth; fostering mutual respect across generations; creating a sense of purpose for retired professionals.	Preservation of traditional skills like woodworking or tailoring; cognitive stimulation for seniors preventing memory decline; improved social-emotional skills for participating children.
Community Integration: Tech-Driven Local Engagement	Low barrier to entry using existing smartphones; savings on transportation costs via telehealth consultations; potential for seniors to participate in the gig economy remotely.	Real-time updates on community events via local apps; instant connection to neighbors for grocery delivery or odd jobs; eliminating travel time for social clubs.	Bridging the digital divide through neighbor-led tech training; maintaining family connections via video calls; building virtual support groups for specific health challenges.	Gaining digital literacy skills essential for the modern world; mental sharpness from learning new software; reduced depression through constant social access.

Model Answers:

3.5–4.5 (B2):

Honestly, I believe the best way to support elderly residents is through financial and healthcare policy changes. The biggest issue for most retirees is that they live on a fixed income while prices keep going up. If local governments could lower property taxes for seniors or provide subsidies for expensive prescription drugs, it would take away a lot of their daily stress. This extra money allows them to actually enjoy their retirement rather than worrying about bankruptcy. On top of that, we should digitize health records to speed up medical appointments. When a geriatric specialist can see a patient's history instantly, it reduces wait times and

4.5–5.0 (C1):

I think the most effective approach is creating intergenerational mentorship programs within our local community centers. The thing is, many seniors suffer from extreme isolation after they retire, which leads to rapid cognitive decline. By pairing retired professionals with local students for weekly tutoring or storytelling sessions, we give these older adults a renewed sense of purpose and a way to share their lifelong skills. This social interaction provides the mental stimulation necessary to prevent memory issues. Furthermore, it fosters a unique sense of mutual respect because young people learn traditional crafts like woodworking or tailoring while the seniors feel deeply valued by the

Q4: Good points. Lastly, looking to the future, do you think society's attitudes toward aging will change? For example, do y

Brainstorming Table:

Answer Angle	\$ (Money)	Time	Ppl (Connection)	Extra (Skill/Health)
Continue Working (Economic Necessity Focus)	Rising inflation outpaces fixed pension plans; healthcare costs for chronic conditions require active income; national social security systems are becoming insolvent.	Phased retirement allows for 20-hour work weeks; eliminates the 'cliff' effect of stopping work abruptly; shifts time from passive leisure to productive output.	Workplaces become multigenerational hubs; older employees mentor Gen Z staff on soft skills; maintains professional networks that prevent senior isolation.	Cognitive stimulation from complex tasks delays dementia; seniors must learn new digital tools to remain employable; physical movement at work reduces sedentary lifestyle risks.
Continue Working (Self-Actualization & Purpose Focus)	Discretionary income allows for luxury travel and high-end hobbies; financial independence prevents being a burden on adult children; allows for philanthropic donating.	Structuring the week around projects provides a sense of daily rhythm; avoids the 'boredom trap' of unstructured retirement years; maximizes the most experienced years.	Status and identity remain tied to professional achievements; provides a sense of belonging to a team; facilitates networking with younger, diverse demographics.	Maintaining a 'growth mindset' through lifelong learning; psychological benefits of feeling needed by society; mastery of new industry technologies keeps the brain plastic.
Prioritize Retirement (Health & Leisure Focus)	Downsizing to smaller homes reduces property tax and maintenance; shifting from accumulation to decumulation of assets; spending shifts toward local community wellness.	Total control over the 24-hour cycle; time for long-delayed personal projects like gardening or writing; flexibility to travel during off-peak seasons.	Focus shifts to deep family bonds and grand-parenting; involvement in local volunteer organizations; strengthening ties with other retirees through social clubs.	Significant reduction in cortisol and work-related stress; ability to focus on preventative health like daily swimming or yoga; recovery from decades of burnout.
Prioritize Retirement (Societal Shift & Tech Focus)	Automation and AI reduce the demand for human labor; Universal Basic Income (UBI) may support non-working populations; lower consumption lifestyles become more trendy.	Technology handles chores, freeing up 40+ hours a week; society redefines 'productivity' as creative or communal rather than corporate; emphasis on slow-living.	Rise of intentional retirement communities; digital platforms allow seniors to connect globally without working; focus on peer-to-peer hobby groups.	Focus on spiritual or philosophical growth in later life; learning skills purely for joy rather than marketability; adaptation to assistive tech for aging in place.

Model Answers:

3.5–4.5 (B2):

Honestly, I believe society will shift toward older people working longer because staying active gives them a sense of purpose. The biggest thing for me is that your identity and status are often tied to your professional achievements. When people retire early, they often fall into a boredom trap where they feel useless or disconnected from the world. By staying in the workforce, they can maintain a growth mindset and keep their brains healthy by learning how to use new software or digital tools. Plus, being part of a team allows them to mentor younger staff, which creates a meaningful social connection and makes them feel

4.5–5.0 (C1):

For me, I think retirement will remain a huge priority because people are starting to value their health and leisure time over a paycheck. The main reason is that decades of high-pressure work lead to massive burnout, and seniors want to spend their later years reducing their stress levels. When someone stops working, their cortisol levels drop because they are no longer dealing with deadlines or boss demands. This freedom allows them to focus on preventative health, like going for a daily swim or practicing yoga, which helps them live longer. On top of that, people want to prioritize deep family bonds, such as helping Raise their grandchildren or traveling with

Set 2: Social Media and Online Identity

You have agreed to participate in a research study about social media and online identity. You will have a short online interview with a researcher. The researcher will ask you some questions.

Q1: Thank you for participating today. I'd like to ask you some questions about social media.

First, is it important to you to have an active presence on social media? Why or why not?

Q2: I see. Imagine you could only keep one social media account and had to delete all the others. Would you keep a platform focused on photos and short videos, or one focused on text-based discussions and news? Which would you choose, and why?

Q3: OK. Next, I'd like to ask your opinion. Some people believe that spending time on social media is just as valuable as reading a book or watching the news, because you can learn things and connect with others. Do you agree or disagree? Why or why not?

Q4: Good points. Lastly, many employers now review job candidates' social media profiles before making hiring decisions. How could this practice affect job seekers and workplaces in positive and negative ways? Explain your answer.

Set 2: Interview Aids

Q1: Thank you for participating today. I'd like to ask you some questions about social media. First, is it important to you

Brainstorming Table:

Answer Angle	\$ (Money)	Time	Ppl (Connection)	Extra (Skill/Health)
Yes: Professional Growth and Networking	Access to freelance job listings on LinkedIn; ability to showcase a digital portfolio to global recruiters; saving on costly traditional headhunter fees.	Real-time industry updates via Twitter/X feeds; immediate notification of application deadlines; reducing months of job searching through direct messaging.	Building a global network of mentors; joining specialized professional communities like GitHub or Behance; staying visible to former colleagues for referrals.	Developing digital literacy and personal branding skills; gaining public speaking confidence through video content; learning to manage a professional online reputation.
Yes: Social Connectivity and Community	Finding local deals or second-hand goods in Facebook Marketplace; splitting travel costs through group coordination; free messaging replacing international calling plans.	Instant scheduling of group events; keeping up with long-distance friends' lives without long individual phone calls; quick access to local community news.	Maintaining bonds with family members living abroad; finding support groups for niche hobbies or health conditions; preventing feelings of isolation in remote areas.	Exposure to diverse cultural perspectives and global news; emotional support during personal milestones; practicing foreign language skills with native speakers.
No: Mental Health and Well-being focus	Avoiding the 'lifestyle creep' caused by influencer marketing; saving money by not purchasing trending products; reducing impulsive shopping triggered by targeted ads.	Eliminating 'doomscrolling' which wastes hours of evening rest; regaining deep-work focus by removing notification distractions; more time for physical exercise.	Prioritizing high-quality face-to-face interactions; avoiding the superficial 'likes' system; reducing social anxiety caused by constant comparison with others' highlight reels.	Lowering levels of cortisol and stress-related fatigue; improving sleep quality by avoiding blue light before bed; developing a stronger internal sense of self-worth.
No: Privacy and Data Security focus	Reducing the risk of identity theft and financial fraud; preventing credit card details from being scraped; avoiding price discrimination based on browsing data.	Saving time spent managing complex privacy settings; zero time lost on recovering hacked accounts or deleting spam; no need to curate a perfectionist digital image.	Protecting the privacy of family and children; fostering authentic relationships that don't rely on public validation; maintaining a clear boundary between work and private life.	Gaining peace of mind through anonymity; protecting personal safety from potential stalkers or data brokers; focused development of hobbies without external pressure to post.

Model Answers:

3.5–4.5 (B2):

Honestly, I find social media essential for staying connected with my community and saving money. The biggest thing for me is the marketplace where people sell second hand goods locally. Last month I found a used desk for half the price of a new one, and I even split the delivery cost with a neighbor I met through a local group. On top of that, it helps me maintain bonds with my cousins who moved abroad. Instead of paying for expensive international calling plans, we just send quick video messages and photos throughout the day, which makes the long distance feel much smaller and keeps our family tight.

4.5–5.0 (C1):

For me, maintaining an active social media profile isn't a priority because I prefer to protect my mental well-being. The thing is, scrolling through these platforms often leads to lifestyle creep since you're constantly bombarded by targeted ads for products you don't actually need. By staying offline, I've noticed I make far fewer impulsive purchases and save a significant amount of money. More importantly, removing those digital distractions has helped me regain my deep-work focus. Instead of wasting three hours every evening on doomscrolling, I can actually dedicate that time to physical exercise or reading, which lowers my stress levels and honestly improves my sleep quality because I'm avoiding that blue light exposure right before

Q2: I see. Imagine you could only keep one social media account and had to delete all the others. Would you keep a platform

Brainstorming Table:

Answer Angle	\$ (Money)	Time	Ppl (Connection)	Extra (Skill/Health)
Visual Media (Option A) – Career & Financial Growth Focus	Directly monetize creative skills through visual portfolios; attract brand sponsorships by showcasing physical product results; lower advertising costs for small businesses through viral video reach.	Streamline learning through 60-second 'how-to' tutorials; reduce time spent reading long manuals by watching visual demonstrations; quickly scan trends via image grids rather than dense threads.	Build a global professional brand through a visual identity; connect with visual learners and creators in the design industry; maintain long-distance friendships through the intimacy of seeing faces and daily life snippets.	Develop high-level video editing and photography skills; improve aesthetic sensibilities and spatial awareness; boost mood through high-quality, inspiring travel or nature cinematography.
Visual Media (Option A) – Personal Well-being & Social Connection Focus	Save money by following DIY home repair videos; find budget travel inspiration through user-generated visual guides; reduce spending by seeing real-life reviews of products in action.	Efficiently capture and archive personal memories without writing journals; spend less time explaining complex emotions by sharing a single expressive photo; use visual cues to quickly decide on weekend activities.	Strengthen family bonds by sharing milestones like a child's first steps; reduce feelings of isolation by seeing friends' real-life environments; engage in community challenges like fitness transformations or art prompts.	Enhance mental health through 'vlog' style therapy and mindfulness content; improve physical health by following visual workout routines; spark creativity by curating digital mood boards for personal projects.
Text-Based Media (Option B) – Intellectual Growth & News Focus	Access real-time financial news and stock market alerts; find deep-dive threads on personal budgeting and tax strategies; avoid the 'impulse buy' pressure often triggered by polished lifestyle photography.	Gain comprehensive knowledge on global events in minutes through bulleted summaries; use keyword searches to find specific information without watching long videos; read at a personalized pace to maximize retention.	Engage in nuanced debates with experts in niche fields; build a network based on shared ideas and philosophies rather than appearances; join text-based support groups for specific life challenges or hobbies.	Sharpen critical thinking by analyzing different viewpoints in comment threads; improve writing and articulation skills through regular posting; stay mentally sharp by processing complex linguistic information daily.
Text-Based Media (Option B) – Productivity & Information Management Focus	Discover freelance opportunities through text-based job boards and networking threads; learn about scholarship or grant opportunities through academic circles; follow consumer advocacy accounts for product warnings.	Eliminate the 'infinite scroll' fatigue caused by autoplay videos; quickly skim headlines during short breaks to stay informed; schedule posts and interact with text more efficiently than producing high-effort video content.	Foster deep intellectual connections through long-form discussion; participate in 'Ask Me Anything' sessions with industry leaders; maintain a professional network focused on expertise and shared industry news.	Reduce digital eye strain and overstimulation caused by flashing lights and loud video audio; improve reading comprehension and vocabulary; cultivate a longer attention span by engaging with long-form articles and essays.

Model Answers:

3.5–4.5 (B2):

I would definitely choose a visual platform because it is much better for my personal well-being and staying connected. The main thing for me is documenting life milestones with my family. When I share a short video of a significant event, my relatives who live far away feel like they are actually there in the room with me, which builds a much stronger emotional bond than just sending a text message. Also, I use these platforms for practical life skills like home repairs. By watching someone actually perform a DIY project, I can see the specific tools they use and avoid making expensive mistakes.

4.5–5.0 (C1):

I would certainly opt for a text-based platform focused on news and discussion because it really sharpens my critical thinking. The biggest advantage is being able to engage in nuanced debates with experts in various fields. Unlike video platforms that prioritize entertainment, text allows for deep-dive threads where users dissect complex global events or financial strategies. This environment forces me to articulate my own thoughts clearly and process sophisticated information at my own pace. Additionally, it helps me avoid the constant pressure to consume products that usually comes with polished lifestyle photography, allowing me to focus more on substance and factual accuracy in my daily life.

Q3: OK. Next, I'd like to ask your opinion. Some people believe that spending time on social media is just as valuable as re

Brainstorming Table:

Answer Angle	\$ (Money)	Time	Ppl (Connection)	Extra (Skill/Health)
Agree: Focus on Modern Knowledge and Accessibility	Eliminates high costs of hardcover books or news subscriptions; provides free access to industry experts' insights on LinkedIn or Twitter.	Offers micro-learning opportunities during commutes; quickly summarizes long-form documentaries into 5-minute educational threads.	Connects niche enthusiasts instantly across borders; allows direct interaction with authors or journalists via comments.	Develops digital literacy skills; keeps users updated on rapidly-changing technologies that traditional textbooks miss.
Agree: Focus on Community and Mental Well-being	Crowdsources financial advice and budgeting tips from relatable peers; finds local community events that are free to attend.	Reduces time spent searching for support groups; provides immediate real-time feedback on personal problems or questions.	Combats loneliness for marginalized groups; fosters a sense of belonging through shared interests like hobbies or fitness.	Provides emotional validation and mental health awareness; encourages creative self-expression through multimedia posts.
Disagree: Focus on Cognitive Depth and Intellectual Rigor	Prevents impulse buying triggered by targeted social media ads; saves money by investing in high-quality, vetted educational resources.	Avoids the 'doom-scrolling' trap that wastes hours; protects deep-work schedules required for complex learning.	Encourages deep, offline conversations about complex topics; avoids the superficial 'echo chambers' found in comment sections.	Strengthens sustained attention spans; improves critical thinking by engaging with long-form, peer-reviewed arguments.
Disagree: Focus on Accuracy and Emotional Health	Reduces the financial risk of following 'fake news' or unverified financial 'influencers'; avoids the cost of therapy for social media-induced anxiety.	Saves time spent fact-checking viral misinformation; ensures hours spent reading are actually contributing to accurate knowledge.	Reduces toxic 'social comparison' and envy; encourages real-world networking based on merit rather than curated profiles.	Protects sleep cycles by avoiding blue light and dopamine spikes; prevents the spread of misinformation regarding public health.

Model Answers:

3.5–4.5 (B2):

Honestly, I think social media is just as valuable as books because of the community support it provides. The biggest reason is that it helps people find others who are going through the same life challenges. For example, when someone is struggling with a personal problem, they can join a support group and get immediate advice from peers who actually understand them. This reduces loneliness in a way that reading a book by yourself simply cannot do. On top of that, it is great for finding free local events. You can see real-time posts about neighborhood gatherings or fitness groups which encourages you to get out and be social.

4.5–5.0 (C1):

I definitely disagree with this idea because social media lacks the cognitive depth found in books. My main concern is that social media is designed for short attention spans, whereas reading a book requires sustained focus. When you engage with a long-form text, you have to follow complex arguments and think critically about the evidence. On social apps, you just swipe past information, which actually harms your ability to do deep work. Furthermore, social media platforms create echo chambers where you only see opinions you already agree with. This is quite dangerous compared to a well-researched news article that presents multiple perspectives and allows you to build a more balanced understanding of world events without the constant distraction of digital notifications.

Q4: Good points. Lastly, many employers now review job candidates' social media profiles before making hiring decisions. How

Brainstorming Table:

Answer Angle	\$ (Money)	Time	Ppl (Connection)	Extra (Skill/Health)
Supportive: Focus on Workplace Safety and Culture Fit	Reduces turnover costs by filtering out toxic candidates; avoids potential lawsuits from workplace harassment by identifying red-flag behaviors early.	Saves HR departments time during the onboarding phase; prevents months of wasted training on a candidate who doesn't align with company values.	Ensures a harmonious team environment by selecting people with compatible social skills; protects existing employees from aggressive or discriminatory coworkers.	Validates a candidate's soft skills and emotional intelligence; confirms that professional claims on a resume match their real-world communication style.
Supportive: Focus on Brand Reputation and Digital Literacy	Protects company profits by ensuring public-facing employees don't damage the brand's image; identifies candidates with high 'influencer' value who can boost sales.	Streamlines the vetting process for marketing and PR roles; quickly identifies if a candidate has the technical skills to manage digital platforms.	Strengthens the company's community presence by hiring socially active and positive ambassadors; builds trust with clients who research the staff online.	Encourages job seekers to curate a professional digital footprint; rewards candidates who have developed hobby-based skills or portfolios visible on social media.
Opposing: Focus on Privacy Rights and Discrimination Risks	Exposes companies to expensive litigation if candidates claim hiring bias; risks high fines for violating data privacy laws in regions like the EU.	Wastes recruiters' time on irrelevant personal data rather than focusing on technical qualifications; slows down the hiring cycle with unnecessary 'stalking'.	Creates a culture of surveillance and distrust before the employee even starts; unfairly penalizes introverts or those who prefer a private personal life.	Triggers unconscious bias regarding a candidate's age, religion, or health status; causes unnecessary anxiety and mental stress for job seekers who feel watched.
Opposing: Focus on Accuracy and Meritocracy	Leads to poor hiring choices by ignoring highly skilled talent based on a single out-of-context post; results in lost revenue due to a lack of technical expertise.	Forces candidates to spend hours 'sanitizing' their digital history instead of studying for technical interviews or gaining actual job experience.	Discriminates against individuals from different socio-economic backgrounds who may use social media differently or for activism; narrows workplace diversity.	Discourages authenticity and personal growth by forcing everyone into a 'corporate' mold; prevents the hiring of 'diamonds in the rough' who lack a polished online persona.

Model Answers:

3.5–4.5 (B2):

Honestly, I believe checking social media is beneficial because it confirms a candidate's digital literacy and helps protect the brand reputation. The biggest thing for me is that public-facing employees represent the company even when they are off the clock. If a marketing manager has a positive and active online presence, they can actually act as a brand ambassador and build trust with new clients. On top of that, it streamlines the hiring process for creative roles. Recruiters can quickly see if someone has the technical skills to manage platforms or engage an audience, which naturally saves HR a lot of time and

4.5–5.0 (C1):

For me, this practice is quite concerning because it seriously threatens privacy rights and introduces a high risk of discrimination. The primary issue is that recruiters often encounter personal information like a candidate's religion, age, or health status, which has nothing to do with their job performance. This can trigger unconscious bias and lead to unfair hiring decisions. Furthermore, it creates a culture of constant surveillance that causes massive anxiety for job seekers. They feel forced to hide their true selves or sanitize their personal lives just to stay competitive. This environment of distrust really damages the relationship between a new hire and the company before the first day even